Nobita and the Remote of Regret

By Palak Kamthan

Nobita sat on his bedroom floor, tears welling in his eyes. On the rug lay a school test paper marked with a large, red circle—a zero that felt like a heavy weight on his shoulders. He wished more than anything that he could simply erase the morning and start all over again.

"Don't cry, Nobita!" Doraemon said, hopping out of the desk drawer and reaching into his 4D pocket. He pulled out a sleek, silver device with a single glowing blue button. "This is the Instant-Undo Remote. It lets you take back any mistake you make within the last five minutes!"

Nobita's eyes widened with joy. He wanted to test it immediately. He reached for a glass of juice on his table and intentionally tipped it over. Before the sticky liquid could soak into the carpet, he clicked the blue button. The juice leaped back into the glass as if by magic, leaving the rug perfectly dry.

Feeling like a master of his own fate, Nobita ran outside to find his friend Masa for a game of catch. When Nobita threw the ball wildly, sending it crashing into a neighbor's potted plant, he simply clicked the remote. The ball flew back into his hand, and the plant stood upright and unbroken once more.

Soon, Nobita was using the remote for every little thing. He rewound time when he tripped on a pebble, when he stuttered over a word while talking to friends, and even when he missed a joke. He felt invincible, as if he were living a life where nothing could ever go wrong.

Back at the house, Doraemon sat on the desk, watching Nobita through the window with a worried expression. He knew that life wasn't meant to be a series of perfect, edited takes. He worried that by avoiding every small struggle, Nobita was forgetting how to actually grow.

"Nobita, I think you should stop using that," Doraemon warned when Nobita returned home. "Mistakes are how we learn to be better. If you undo everything, you're not really living your own life!" But Nobita just laughed, waving the remote in the air. "Why should I suffer when I can be perfect?"

That evening, Nobita sat alone in the park, but he realized he felt strangely bored. Since nothing could go wrong, nothing felt exciting anymore. Every "win" felt hollow because he hadn't actually earned it, and his conversations felt rehearsed and fake.

Doraemon didn't give him a new gadget. Instead, they sat together at the table, carefully using glue to fix the cracked frames of Nobita's glasses. Nobita realized that the hard work and the lesson learned made the glasses feel more valuable than if they had never broken at all.